

Second-hand PCs

A First-hand Report

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Can anyone's scrapped system, be someone else's dream machine? Well, this certainly holds true in the second-hand PC market. Just because your PC can't run the latest game doesn't mean it's trash. It can possibly perform mundane office tasks. Many don't know this, but there exists a large secondary PC market out there — with its own set of rules of participation and provision. A stream of such so-called obsolete PCs form the foundation of this market. Some consumers frequently upgrade their PCs and sell their old ones in the second-hand market — largely in the metros. A significant portion of these proliferate to rural areas, where people may not have the means or inclination to invest in the latest configurations. Such second-hand machines also find their way to educational institutes, offices, and businesses, in tier II and III cities. A Gartner report states that "one in every 12 PCs in use worldwide is a secondary PC." An estimated 10 per cent is donated to NGOs and other non-profit organisations. Let's try to understand the specifics of the second-hand PC market by answering some fundamental questions.

Why would you want a second-hand computer?

Well the simplest and quickest answer to that question is price! People who buy a refurb-

Today's PCs may be more powerful than ever before, but what about affordability? Second-hand PCs offer the perfect budget solution for your small office.

bished or a second-hand computer generally fall into one of two categories. The first category of people need a computer for fairly standard tasks such as internet browsing, word processing, spreadsheet work, etc. Applications of this nature have not changed much over the years in terms of the demands that they make on a computer's resources. Therefore, a second-hand computer which may be a few years old, would be quite capable of running even modern versions of these programs and at a fraction of the price of a brand-new machine. Besides, when you're running such mundane tasks, a brand new machine can be an expensive overkill. The second category of users might require a

